

LOGAN LEAK, PHD

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EDUCATION

Stanford University | Stanford, CA
Doctor of Philosophy in Cancer Biology
 GPA: 4.00/4.00

Degree conferred September 12, 2024

The University of Chicago | Chicago, IL
Bachelors of Science in Biological Sciences (specialization in cancer biology)
 Overall GPA: 3.960 / Major GPA: 3.973

Diploma with General Honors, June 2019

EXPERIENCE

Fulbright Commission | Amsterdam, Netherlands | *Fulbright Scholar*

August 2026 – December 2026 (planned)

- Working in Rene Bernards Lab at the Netherlands Cancer Institute to identify genetic regulators of tyrosine kinase inhibitor sensitivity and resistance in EML4-ALK positive non-small cell lung cancer

Nucleate | Bay Area, CA | *Finalist*

November 2025 – Present

- Advanced to finalist status as Chief Scientific Officer of an early-stage startup developing a novel functional genomics companion diagnostic for cancer

University of California, San Francisco | San Francisco, CA | *Postdoctoral Scholar*

February 2025 – Present

- Studying and developing therapies for non-small cell lung cancer in Trevor Bivona's laboratory
- Understanding the regulation and signaling of granule-forming oncogenic fusion proteins
- NSF I-Corps trainee assessing market viability and identifying customers for biotech products
- Completed Startup 101 course to understand how to turn academic discoveries into commercial operations

Stanford University Department of Biology | Stanford, CA | *Postdoctoral Scholar*

September 2024 – December 2024

- Conducting follow-on experiments to complete publication of my graduate school project (see below)

Stanford University Department of Biology | Stanford, CA | *PhD Candidate*

September 2019 – September 2024

- Characterized a novel cell death pathway called using cellular and molecular biology assays (see publications section)
- Established a protocol for detecting ferroptosis in cultured cells (see publications section)
- Published a review article on the diversity of non-apoptotic cell death pathways (see publications section)
- Applied computational cancer clonality models to AML patient data to identify features that correlate with patient outcomes, resulting in a second-author paper (see publications section)

Civilization Ventures | Bay Area, California | *Fellow*

May 2024 – July 2024

- Learn how to source, diligence, and decide on venture capital deals for early-stage biomedical startups
- Engage with other fellows to analyze companies and synthesize investment memos for consideration by the VC firm

Biotech Connection Bay Area (BCBA) | Bay Area, California | *Consultant*

July 2023 - September 2023

- Performed due diligence investigations into 30 diseases to prioritize a short list of indications for a renal gene therapy company
- Provided recommendations to company executives via an oral presentation with a distilled slide deck of key findings
- Conducted 5 interviews with key opinion leaders to assess path-to-clinic viability for various disease indications

Stanford Biotechnology Group (SBG) | Stanford, California | *Communications Team*

September 2023 – December 2024

- Implement strategic marketing and outreach initiatives to attract Stanford community members to SBG events
- Engage in outreach to biotechnology companies to promote connections with Stanford graduate students

Pre-doctoral Research Experiences:

- Comer Children's Hospital* (Chicago, IL, June 2018 - September 2019): Assessed efficacy of p53/BCL-2 dual-targeting nanoparticles for targeted delivery to diffuse large B cell lymphoma cells as a cancer therapy and contributed to two published articles on this topic (see publications section)
- Case Western Reserve University* (Cleveland, OH, June 2017 - September 2017): Determined how the extracellular vesicles of HIV-infected T cells increase incidence of head and neck cancer, lung cancer, and other non-AIDS defining cancers and published in a student research journal (see publications section)
- The University of Chicago* (Chicago, IL, October 2016 - June 2017): Worked as a laboratory technician to genotype mice and support experiments investigating the role of mitophagy in cancer
- Case Western Reserve University* (Cleveland, OH, August 2015 - May 2016): Performed flow cytometry experiments to assess how immune markers change with age

- *NYU Langone Healthcare* (Brooklyn, NY, August 2014 - May 2015): Retroactively evaluated the APACHE II scoring system for sepsis patients to provide evidence for future implementation

Stanford Office of Sustainability | Stanford, CA | *Green Labs Intern*

September 2021 – September 2022

- Organized two Lab Share events to foster sharing and reuse of hundreds of unwanted laboratory items
- Hosted a laboratory sustainability week for graduate students to learn more about reducing laboratory waste
- Led information campaigns and provided supplies to improve waste sorting in laboratories on campus
- Wrote a review article on the various ways to promote laboratory sustainability (see publications section)

PUBLICATIONS

- 2025 – **Leak, L.**, Wang, Z., Joseph, A., Johnson, B., Chan, A., Decosto, C.M., Magtanong, L., Ko, P.J., Lee, W.C., Ritho, Manukian, S., Millner, A., Chitkara, S., Salinas, J.J., J., Skouta, R., Rees, M.G., Ronan, M.M., Roth, J.A., Myers, C.L., Moffat, J., Boone, C., Bensinger, S.J., Nathanson, D.A., Atilla-Gokcumen, G.E., and Dixon, S. “Tegavivint triggers TECR-dependent nonapoptotic cancer cell death.” *Nature Chemical Biology* ([link](#), open access pre-print: [link](#)).
- 2025 - **Leak, L.**, Bergo, H. C., and Bivona, T. G. (2025). Condensates as a culprit in RAS activation and inhibitor resistance. *Cancer Research* ([link](#)).
- 2023 – Schnorenberg, M., Hawley, K., Thomas-Toth, E., Tian, Y., Ting, J., **Leak, L.**, Kucera, I., Raczy, M., Kung, A., Hubbell, J., Tirrell, M., LaBelle, J. “Targeted Polymersome Delivery of a Stapled Peptide for Drugging the Tumor Protein p53:BCL-2-Family Axis in Diffuse Large B-Cell Lymphoma.” *ACS Nano* ([link](#)).
- 2023 - **Leak, L.**, Murray, M., and Lee, W. “Protocol for detection of ferroptosis in cultured cells.” *STAR Protocols* ([link](#)).
- 2023 – **Leak, L.** and Dixon, S. “Surveying the Landscape of Emerging and Understudied Non-apoptotic Cell Death Mechanisms.” *Biochimica et Biophysica Acta Molecular Cell Research* ([link](#)).
- 2023 – **Leak, L.**, Tamborski, J., Commissaris, A., & Brophy, J. A. “Forging a path toward a more sustainable laboratory.” *Trends in Biochemical Sciences*. ([link](#)).
- 2022 (abstract) – **Leak, L.** and Dixon, S. “A novel cell death mechanism involving the sphingosine to glycerophospholipid pathway.” *The Journal of the Federation of American Societies for Experimental Biology* ([link](#)).
- 2021 – Benard, B., **Leak, L.**, Azizi, A., Thomas, D., Gentles, A., and Majeti, R. “Clonal architecture and variant allele frequency predict clinical outcomes and drug response in acute myeloid leukemia.” *Nature Communications* ([link](#)).
- 2019 - Hadji, A., Schmitt, G., Schnorenberg, M., Roach, L., Hickey, C., **Leak, L.**, Tirrell, M., and LaBelle, J. “Preferential Targeting of MCL-1 by a Hydrocarbon-Stapled BIM BH3 Peptide.” *Oncotarget* ([link](#)).
- 2018 – **Leak, L.**, Chen, L., Ye, D., and Jin, G. “Immune Checkpoint Expression in Peripheral Blood Mononuclear Cells Treated with Conditioned Media from Head and Neck and Lung Cancer Cells.” *Scientia* research journal at the University of Chicago ([link](#)).

OUTREACH AND SERVICE

- *Stanford Graduate Life Office Head Community Associate (2020-2024)*: Foster community in graduate student housing by hosting events for students to destress, meet their neighbors, and learn about university resources.
- *Sunrise Silicon Valley (2019-2022)*: Served as actions lead for a local chapter of the Sunrise Movement, a national youth-led organization fighting for climate justice.
- *Stanford Biosciences Student Association Wellness Chair (2020-2021)*: Provided wellness resources for the Biosciences community during the COVID-19 pandemic, led efforts to hire psychologists and psychiatrists for students within the School of Medicine ([website](#)), received the Stanford Alumni Association Community Impact Award for these efforts.
- *University of Chicago Science Olympiad (2016-2019)*: Founded and served as president of a science outreach organization that has brought high-quality extracurricular STEM enrichment activities to hundreds of K-12 students in the Chicagoland area ([website](#)).
- *Science Olympiad (2016-present)*: Teach students in underserved communities STEM topics through Stanford’s Adopt a Science Olympiad Team Organization ([website](#)). Volunteer for local, regional, and state competitions as an exam writer and proctor for middle and high school students.

SKILLS

Lab Skills:

Drug screening, cell and molecular biology assays, cell culture, cell death assays, western blotting, flow cytometry, qPCR, DNA and RNA processing, cloning, in vivo experiments, computational biology

Computer Skills:

Proficient in Adobe Illustrator, RStudio, Prism, Microsoft Office Suite

Programming languages: R, Python, git

Language Proficiencies:

English (native speaker), Spanish (conversational)

HONORS AND AWARDS

Fulbright Scholar Award (U.S. Department of State) – August – December 2026

Best Poster Presentation (Stanford Cancer Institute Annual Retreat) – March 2024

Best Presentation (Stanford Cancer Biology Program Annual Retreat) – October 2022

Stanford Alumni Association Community Impact Award - May 2021

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention – April 8, 2019 & March 30, 2020

Stanford Graduate Fellowship – Gerhard Casper Fellow – March 2019 – June 2022

Phi Beta Kappa – University of Chicago – June 2019

Dean's List (The University of Chicago) – June 2017, June 2018, June 2019

Clinton Global Initiative Resolution Project Fellowship – October 2018

National Merit Scholarship (Eaton Corporation) – April 2016

President's Scholar (The University of Chicago) – March 2016

REFERENCES

Trever Bivona (Postdoc advisor, trever.bivona@ucsf.edu), Scott Dixon (PhD advisor, sjdixon@stanford.edu), Or Gozani (PhD committee member, ogozani@stanford.edu), James Chen (PhD committee member, jameschen@stanford.edu)